REP-076 · Balance study: Good Riddance and shopkeeper perks

Game	Fruit Market (rules version 5)
Report date	2026-10-29 03:12 (Asia/Kuala_Lumpur)
Type	Measurement only. **No game change**
Request	DEC-046 (balance simulations)

STATUS

600 computer games per row (normal level, 10 days, upgrades and events on). Nothing in the game was changed.

GOOD RIDDANCE

It is played rarely: 0.21 times a game with 2 players, 0.13 with 3, 0.10 with 4. A player who plays it wins less often than average (2 players 23% against 53%; 4 players 13% against 25%). That is mostly because the computer plays it when it is already stuck with old fruit, so it is a rescue card, not a winning move. Removing it, keeping one copy, or swapping it for Free Fruit or Fridge changes average cash by less than $1.5 and the winning margin by about 1 to 2 dollars: inside the noise. Seat order stays fair in all versions.

What this means: balance does not decide it. The question is feel: a card whose best use is dumping stock at $1 each. Scout (look at the front of one walk-in arriving today) cannot be simulated honestly because the computer does not use hidden information, so it needs a human playtest.

SHOPKEEPER PERKS (computer play, 2 to 4 stalls, win rate against a fair share)

Perk	2 stalls (fair 50%)	3 stalls (33%)	4 stalls (25%)
Big Basket	61%	50%	40%
Tip Jar	56%	40%	28%
Bargain Hunter	50%	33%	21%
Nest Egg	48%	28%	23%
Charmer	40%	25%	21%
Haggler	47%	24%	17%

Finding: Big Basket is clearly the strongest (40% at 4 stalls, against 25% fair) and Haggler the weakest (17%). Caution: the computer may use Haggler and Charmer less well than a person. This

is a rule change if acted on, so it is your decision: for example, change Big Basket to "buy 1 extra fruit on days 1 to 5", or make Haggler stronger.

OTHER CHECKS FROM THE EXISTING BALANCE RUN

- Seat order: 2 stalls 52/48, 3 stalls 31/33/36, 4 stalls 25/25/28/22. Fair enough.
- Skill: hard beats normal 78% of the time with 2 stalls; normal beats easy 79%.
- Dead days (nothing sold): 0.09 a game with 2 stalls, 0 with 4.
- Leader after day 5 wins about the fair share: comebacks are common.
- The 36-card customer deck: average demand per card matches the old 24 (4.4 pieces, $31.8).

NOT DONE OR NOT VERIFIED

Human play. Every number here is computer against computer.